Jay Stewart

Product engineer. I find out what users need, then ship it with coding agents.

Available now for remote contract work

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PROFILE

Three products shipped solo since March 2026, one taking real payments. Before that, eight years of e-commerce backends on systems that hold other people's money. Looking for contract work with early-stage startups.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Product Engineer · Independent

Mar 2026 – now

SpiralClass `live · real payments` Booking, payments and video for independent teachers. Built and run solo.

- Stripe Connect direct charges: the teacher is merchant of record; the platform never holds funds.
- Next.js, Postgres (82 models), LiveKit video. 9,351 unit tests behind one merge gate, locally and in CI.
- 146 decision records. Cut CI spend by tracing 744 billable minutes a month to one workflow.

WantToJoin `pilot · one hostel` Tonight's hostel outings, and who's going, on one link.

- Read 2,800 guest WhatsApp messages first. Finding: build for the hosts, not the guests.
- Research to live pilot in three days, on Cloudflare Workers and D1.
- Bilingual AI post writer (Claude Haiku), checked in code: 50 of 50 eval drafts pass, about $0.0003 a post.

Beckon `live · open source` Answer a waiting coding agent from your phone. Billing on; no outside users yet.

- End-to-end encrypted. The phone sends a signed choice, never keystrokes.
- Go helper, Next.js and WebSocket service, installable web app with push.
- One hardened VM: encrypted offsite backups, rehearsed restore, dead man's switch. Self-hostable.

Stackquake `building now` Tracks vendor pricing and licence changes; every note quotes its source word for word.

Career break

Mar 2020 – Mar 2026

Six years travelling on savings. Back because coding agents changed what one person can ship.

Backend Engineer · G&V | Venture Brands Agency (contract) · Bristol

Jul 2017 – Mar 2020

- High-traffic e-commerce, including Dyson's store. Fixed production issues where an outage meant lost orders.

Backend Engineer · Thrive Chiropractic (contract, remote)

Aug 2016 – Mar 2020

- Designed, built and ran their booking and payments platform for nearly four years.

Backend Engineer · Folk Digital, Bournemouth; C3 Media, Bristol

Jul 2012 – Aug 2016

- E-commerce backends and integrations; from junior PHP developer to building whole systems.

HOW I WORK

- **Start with users.** Read what they actually say. Change the plan when the evidence does.
- **Write down when to stop.** Hypothesis, measure and stopping rule before any code.
- **I own what the agents write.** Every change gets a pull request, tests and a real-browser check.

SKILLS

Stack	TypeScript, Next.js, React, Node, Postgres, Prisma, Go, Cloudflare Workers; PHP and Magento before 2020
Payments and ops	Stripe Connect, Wise; GitHub Actions, Docker, Hetzner, Cloud Run, Sentry, PostHog
Product and agents	User interviews, experiments, pilots; Claude Code, evals, CI gates, browser testing
Languages	English (native), Spanish (conversational)